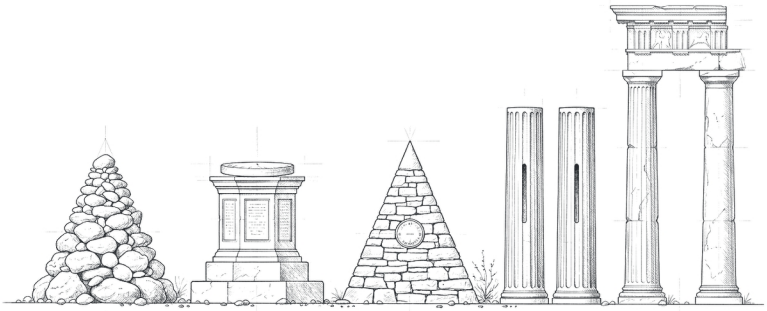
The Five Geodetic Cairns

I. The Markers of the Order

Across the open desert, the Order of the Eclipse raised five sacred cairns to anchor their surveys. Each marker marks a vital turn across the waste, binding the earth to the positions of the sun and stars. In these field sketches, I have recorded the elevation and character of every cairn, that their ancient foundations may be recognized across the sands.



Cairn I Cairn II Cairn III Cairn IV Cairn V

II. The Words of the Servant

When I reached the portico of Tower II, the Sanctuary Servant studied the sandstone seal in my palm and pointed his staff toward the vast basin: «You hold only the first piece of the circuit. The founders raised five sacred cairns to measure this desert; without all five, these doors remain barred forever.» Then, tracing the ancient meridian lines upon the flagstones, he revealed the secret of the fallen stones.

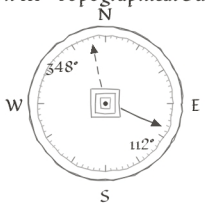
The Memory of the Stones (1971-1998)

«Three of the five cairns collapsed in the autumn of 1971, when the great earthquake shook the basin and the red storm swept across the wastes. For twenty-seven years their foundations lay buried under shifting silt and river sand.

In the autumn of 1998, a young traveler walked the dry wash and raised three mounds of dry stone to guide those who might follow, setting a copper benchmark plate beneath the third. He believed he was merely marking his own trail across the sands. He did not know that his hands were rebuilding the sacred stations of the Order upon their ancient bedrock foundations.

A stone remembers the hand that raises it. That is why your fingers knew the rocks in the riverbed; you were returning to what you had already begun. But Cairns IV and V, far in the southern gorges, never fell. Go back to the sands, surveyor: the desert yields its seals only to the one who walks the complete meridian.»

Cairn III · Topographical Survey



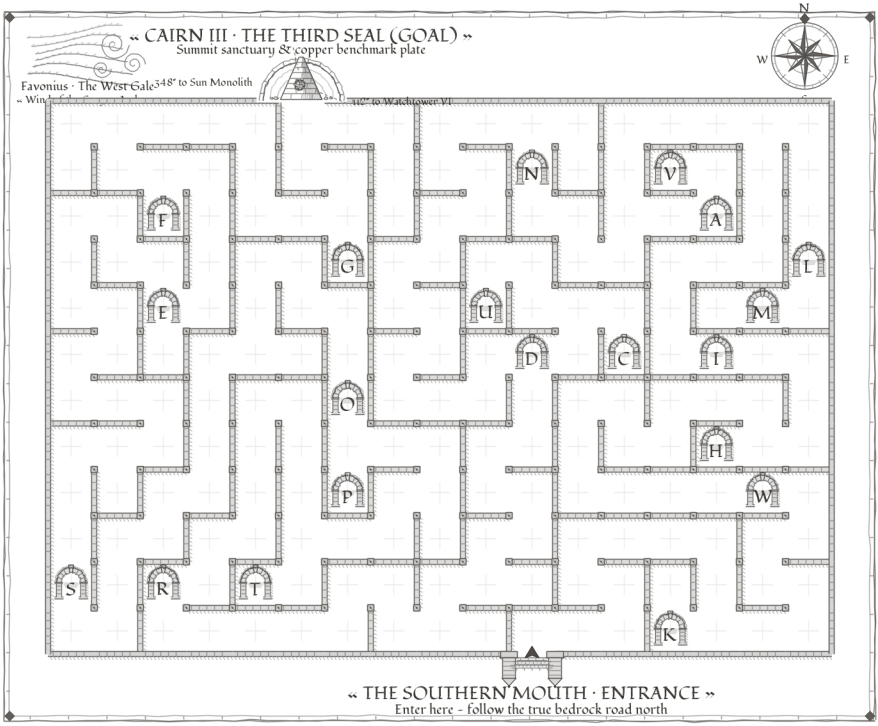
1. The Copper Benchmark (1998): Set at 112° E, pointing toward Outer Watchtower VI across the northern sands.
2. The Bedrock Groove (Ancient): Cut into the foundation at 348° NNW, aligned directly with the Sun Monolith.
3. The Sandstone Labyrinth: Cairn III crowns the deep fissures ahead. Trace the true route on Sheet 14B to recover the third seal.

Meridian Alignment: The 348° axis connects directly with the solar line of Tower II. Walk north across the plateau.

The Sandstone Labyrinth & Cairn III

I. The Arches of the West Wind

North of the Sun Monolith, the open desert rises into a wild plateau of wind-carved sandstone. Here, centuries of scouring gales have sculpted a labyrinth of towering pillars, narrow fissures, and natural arches. Deep within this maze stands Cairn III, guarding the third seal of the Order beneath its copper benchmark plate. The ancient wagon tracks have long vanished beneath shifting sand, but the bedrock itself remembers the way.



II. The Tablet at the Mouth

At the entrance to the gorge, half-buried in silt, stands a weather-worn sandstone stele left by the early surveyors. Before stepping between the towering walls, I copied its inscription into my log:

> «Only one continuous road cuts through the labyrinth from this entrance to the summit of Cairn III. Eight stone arches stand upon that true path, each bearing a single letter. Follow the way step by step, reading the arches in the exact order you pass beneath them. Heed not the shadows of the side fissures: the arches that lie off the path are false.»

The Sigil of Cairn III:

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8

Speak this eight-letter name at Cairn III to unlock its copper plate and claim the third seal.